

Word family: **file** / **files** / **filed** / **filing** / **filer**

Base word: file

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

- * **file** (n.) — 檔案；文件；卷宗；鋸刀；縱列
- * **file** (v.) — 把文件歸檔；提交；申報；排成縱列前進；用鋸刀鋸
- * **filing** (n.) — 歸檔；正式提交；申報；鋸屑
- * **filer** (n.) — 提交 / 申報文件的人或機構
- * **filed** (adj./participle) — 已歸檔的；已提交的
- * **file system / filesystem** — 檔案系統
- * **filename / file name** — 檔案名稱
- * **file format** — 檔案格式
- * **file extension** — 副檔名 / 檔案副檔名

Useful expressions / extensions:

- * **open a file**
- * **save a file**
- * **upload a file**
- * **download a file**
- * **delete a file**
- * **attach a file**
- * **share a file**
- * **file a document**
- * **file a complaint**
- * **file a claim**
- * **file a lawsuit**
- * **file taxes**
- * **file for bankruptcy**
- * **file for divorce**
- * **file away**
- * **on file**
- * **keep something on file**
- * **case file**
- * **personnel file**
- * **medical file**
- * **single file**
- * **file past**
- * **metal file**
- * **nail file**

Meaning in this passage

> Later that evening, Kevin checked the shared folder again and realised that he had opened the wrong **file**.

Here, **file** means:

an individual digital item containing information, such as a presentation, document, image, or spreadsheet — 電子檔案

Kevin had opened the wrong digital item inside the shared folder.

中文翻譯：

Kevin 再次檢查共享資料夾，才發現自己打開了錯的**檔案**。

So here:

file = 儲存在電腦、手機、雲端或其他數碼系統中的一個獨立資料單位

1. **file (電子檔案) — 檔案**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He realised that he had opened the wrong **file**.

他才發現自己打開了錯的**檔案**。

Practice 2

> I saved the **file** on my laptop.

我把**檔案**儲存在手提電腦裏。

Practice 3

> Please send me the correct **file**.

請把正確的**檔案**傳給我。

MCQ-ready definition:

file = 儲存在電子裝置或系統中的一個獨立數碼資料單位

2. **open a file — 打開檔案**

Practice 1

> I accidentally **opened the wrong file**.

我不小心**打開了錯的檔案**。

Practice 2

> Double-click to **open the file**.

按兩下以**打開檔案**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****open a file = 用程式載入電子檔案以查看或編輯其內容****

3. **save a file — 儲存檔案**

Practice 1

> Don't forget to **save the file**.

不要忘記**儲存檔案**。

Practice 2

> I **saved the file** under a new name.

我用新名稱**儲存了檔案**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****save a file = 把電子資料保存在裝置或儲存位置，以便日後使用****

4. **download a file — 下載檔案**

Practice 1

> I **downloaded the file** from the shared folder.

我從共享資料夾**下載了檔案**。

Practice 2

> Click here to **download the file**.

按這裏**下載檔案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

download a file = 從網站、伺服器或雲端把檔案傳到自己的裝置

5. **upload a file — 上傳檔案**

Practice 1

> She **uploaded the file** yesterday.

她昨天**上傳了檔案**。

Practice 2

> Make sure you **upload the correct file**.

確保你**上傳正確的檔案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

upload a file = 把自己裝置上的檔案傳到網站、雲端或遠端系統

6. **delete a file — 刪除檔案**

Practice 1

> I accidentally **deleted the file**.

我不小心**刪除了檔案**。

Practice 2

> Don't **delete this file**.

不要**刪除這個檔案**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****delete a file = 從儲存位置移除一個電子檔案****

7. ****attach a file — 附加檔案****

Practice 1

> I ****attached the file**** to the email.

我把檔案****附加到電郵****。

Practice 2

> Please ****attach the file**** before sending the message.

傳送訊息前請先****附加檔案****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****attach a file = 把檔案加入電郵、表格或訊息，隨內容一同傳送****

8. ****share a file — 分享檔案****

Practice 1

> Can you ****share the file**** with the group?

你可以把****檔案分享給小組****嗎？

Practice 2

> The document was ****shared as a file****.

文件以****檔案形式分享****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****share a file = 讓其他人可以存取、查看或下載一個檔案****

9. ****file name / filename — 檔案名稱****

Practice 1

> Check the **file name** carefully.

仔細檢查**檔案名稱**。

Practice 2

> I changed the **filename**.

我更改了**檔案名稱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file name = 用來識別某個電子檔案的名稱

10. **file format — 檔案格式**

Practice 1

> Which **file format** do you need?

你需要甚麼**檔案格式**？

Practice 2

> Save the image in a different **file format**.

把圖片儲存成另一種**檔案格式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file format = 電子檔案用甚麼資料結構和類型儲存的格式

11. **file extension — 副檔名**

Practice 1

> The **file extension** is .pdf.

這個**副檔名**是 .pdf。

Practice 2

> Changing the **file extension** does not always convert the file properly.

只改**副檔名**不一定能真正轉換檔案格式。

MCQ-ready definition:

file extension = 檔名末尾通常用來表示檔案類型的部分，如 .pdf、.docx

12. **file system** — 檔案系統

Practice 1

> The operating system manages the **file system**.

作業系統會管理**檔案系統**。

Practice 2

> The drive uses a different **file system**.

這個磁碟使用不同的**檔案系統**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file system = 電腦用來組織、儲存和尋找檔案及資料夾的系統

13. **file** (紙本文件 / 檔案資料) — 檔案；文件資料

A major physical/administrative noun sense.

Practice 1

> The office keeps a **file** on every employee.

辦公室為每位員工保存一份**檔案資料**。

Practice 2

> She took the **file** from the cabinet.

她從櫃裏拿出那份**檔案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file = 收集在一起、與某人或某件事相關的一組紙本或行政資料

14. **case file — 案件檔案；個案卷宗**

Practice 1

> The detective reviewed the **case file**.

探員查閱了**案件卷宗**。

Practice 2

> Important evidence was added to the **case file**.

重要證據被加入**案件檔案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

case file = 與某宗案件或個案有關的完整文件和紀錄集合

15. **personnel file — 人事檔案**

Practice 1

> The warning was added to his **personnel file**.

那次警告被記錄在他的**人事檔案**中。

Practice 2

> Employee records are kept in confidential **personnel files**.

僱員紀錄保存在機密**人事檔案**中。

MCQ-ready definition:

personnel file = 機構保存、與某名僱員有關的正式工作紀錄

16. **medical file — 醫療檔案；病歷檔案**

Practice 1

> The doctor checked her **medical file**.

醫生查看了她的**醫療檔案**。

Practice 2

> The information was added to his **medical file**.

資料被加入他的**病歷檔案**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****medical file = 記錄某人醫療資料、診斷和治療紀錄的檔案****

17. **on file — 已存檔；已有紀錄**

A very useful fixed expression.

Practice 1

> We have your address **on file**.

我們已有你的地址**存檔**。

Practice 2

> The company keeps all contracts **on file**.

公司把所有合約**存檔備查**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on file = 資料已被正式保存，日後可以查閱****

18. **keep something on file — 把.....存檔**

Practice 1

> We'll **keep your application on file**.

我們會把你的申請**存檔備查**。

Practice 2

> Keep a copy **on file**.

保留一份副本**存檔**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****keep X on file = 把 X 正式保存作日後參考****

19. ****file (verb : 歸檔) — 歸檔 ; 存檔****

Practice 1

> Please ****file these documents****.

請把這些文件****歸檔****。

Practice 2

> The reports were ****filed alphabetically****.

報告按字母順序****歸檔****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file documents = 按某種系統把文件整理並保存，以便日後查找****

20. ****file away — 收好歸檔****

Practice 1

> She ****filed the letter away****.

她把信件****收好歸檔****。

Practice 2

> The records were ****filed away**** for future reference.

紀錄被****歸檔保存****，以供日後查閱。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file away X = 把 X 收進檔案系統保存起來****

21. **file** (verb : 正式提交) — 提交 ; 呈交

A major separate verb branch.

Practice 1

> She **filed a complaint**.

她正式**提出投訴**。

Practice 2

> The lawyer **filed the documents** with the court.

律師向法院正式**提交文件**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file something = 向法院、政府、機構等正式提交文件或申請，使其成為正式紀錄

22. **file a complaint** — 正式提出投訴

Practice 1

> He **filed a complaint** against the company.

他正式對公司**提出投訴**。

Practice 2

> Customers can **file a complaint** online.

顧客可以在網上**提交正式投訴**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file a complaint = 向有關機構正式提出並記錄投訴

23. **file a claim** — 提出索償 / 申索

Practice 1

> She **filed an insurance claim**.

她向保險公司**提出索償**。

Practice 2

> You must **file the claim** within thirty days.

你必須在三十日內**提交申索**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file a claim = 正式提交要求賠償、付款或權利的申請

24. **file a lawsuit — 提起訴訟**

Practice 1

> The company **filed a lawsuit**.

公司**提起訴訟**。

Practice 2

> She **filed a lawsuit against** her former employer.

她對前僱主**提出法律訴訟**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file a lawsuit = 正式向法院啟動民事訴訟程序

25. **file charges — 正式提出刑事控罪**

Practice 1

> Prosecutors decided to **file charges**.

檢控人員決定正式**提出控罪**。

Practice 2

> No charges were **filed**.

最終沒有正式**提出控罪**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file charges = 依法正式提出刑事指控****

26. ****file taxes / file a tax return — 報稅；提交報稅表****

Practice 1

> I need to ****file my taxes****.

我需要****報稅****。

Practice 2

> She ****filed her tax return**** online.

她在網上****提交了報稅表****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file taxes/a tax return = 向稅務機關正式提交所需的稅務資料****

27. ****file for something — 正式申請 / 提出.....****

Practice 1

> The company ****filed for bankruptcy****.

公司正式****申請破產****。

Practice 2

> They ****filed for divorce****.

他們正式****提出離婚申請****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file for X = 向有關機構正式申請某種法律或行政身份 / 程序****

28. ****file for bankruptcy — 申請破產****

Practice 1

> The business **filed for bankruptcy** after years of losses.

企業連年虧損後**申請破產**。

Practice 2

> Several companies **filed for bankruptcy**.

數家公司**提出破產申請**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file for bankruptcy = 正式啟動法律上的破產程序

29. **file for divorce** — 提出離婚申請

Practice 1

> She **filed for divorce** last year.

她去年正式**提出離婚申請**。

Practice 2

> The couple decided to **file for divorce**.

那對夫婦決定正式**申請離婚**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file for divorce = 向法院正式提出終止婚姻的申請

30. **filing** (正式提交的文件 / 申報) — 正式提交文件；申報

Practice 1

> The company's latest regulatory **filing** was published yesterday.

公司最新的監管**申報文件**昨天公布。

Practice 2

> The court **filing** contains several new details.

法院的**提交文件**包含幾項新資料。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****filing = 正式向法院、政府或監管機構提交的文件或提交行為****

31. ****filing system — 歸檔系統****

Practice 1

> The office needs a better ****filing system****.

辦公室需要更好的****歸檔系統****。

Practice 2

> Our digital ****filing system**** is easy to use.

我們的數碼****檔案管理系統****很容易使用。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****filing system = 用來分類、保存和尋找文件的組織方法****

32. ****file (銼刀) — 銼刀****

A completely separate physical noun sense.

Practice 1

> He smoothed the metal with a ****file****.

他用****銼刀****把金屬磨平。

Practice 2

> Use a fine ****file**** on the rough edge.

用幼細的****銼刀****處理粗糙邊緣。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file = 表面有細齒，用來磨平或修整金屬、木材等的工具****

33. **nail file — 指甲銼**

Practice 1

> She used a **nail file** to smooth her nails.

她用**指甲銼**把指甲邊緣磨平。

Practice 2

> I keep a **nail file** in my bag.

我袋裏放了一把**指甲銼**。

MCQ-ready definition:

nail file = 用來修整和平滑指甲邊緣的小型銼具

34. **file (verb : 用銼刀磨) — 銼 ; 磨平**

Practice 1

> He **filed the metal edge smooth**.

他把金屬邊緣**銼平**。

Practice 2

> She **filed her nails**.

她用指甲銼**修整指甲**。

MCQ-ready definition:

file something = 用銼刀磨去少量材料，使表面或邊緣變平整

35. **filings (銼屑) — 銼屑 ; 細碎屑**

Usually plural.

Practice 1

> Metal **filings** covered the workbench.

工作檯上滿是金屬**銼屑**。

Practice 2

> Iron **filings** are often used in science demonstrations.

科學示範中常用鐵**屑**。

MCQ-ready definition:

filings = 用銼磨物料時產生的細小碎屑

36. **file** (縱列；一路縱隊) — 縱列

A distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> The students walked in **single file**.

學生**排成一路縱隊**前進。

Practice 2

> They moved through the narrow path in **file**.

他們沿着狹窄小路**排成縱列**前進。

MCQ-ready definition:

file = 一個接一個排列的人或物形成的縱列

37. **single file** — 一路縱隊；一個接一個

Practice 1

> Please walk in **single file**.

請**排成一路縱隊**行走。

Practice 2

> The children entered the room in ****single file****.

孩子們****一個接一個****進入房間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****single file = 每人站在前一人後面，排成一條直線****

38. ****file into / out of somewhere — 排成縱列進入 / 離開****

Practice 1

> The students ****filed into the hall****.

學生們****一個接一個地走進禮堂****。

Practice 2

> People slowly ****filed out of the building****.

人們慢慢****魚貫走出大樓****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file into/out of somewhere = 一個接一個、有秩序地進入或離開某地方****

39. ****file past — 魚貫經過****

Practice 1

> Visitors ****filed past**** the display.

訪客****一個接一個地走過****展品。

Practice 2

> The soldiers ****filed past**** the gate.

士兵們****排成縱列經過****大門。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****file past = 排成一列，一個接一個從某人 / 某物旁邊經過****

Important distinction 1: **file** vs **folder**

Crucial for your passage.

file

the individual digital item.

folder

the container used to organize files.

> folder = 資料夾

> file = 檔案

Kevin checked the **folder**, then realized he had opened the wrong **file**.

Important distinction 2: **file** vs **document**

file

technical container/data item.

document

the content/type of material.

A Word document is a **document**, but the saved .docx is also a **file**.

Not every file is a document:

* image file

* audio file

* video file

Important distinction 3: **file** vs **record**

file

collection/item stored for reference.

record

information kept as evidence/history.

> personnel file

人事檔案

> attendance record

出席紀錄

A file may contain many records.

Important distinction 4: **file noun vs file verb**

Noun

> Open the file.

打開檔案。

Verb

> File the document.

把文件歸檔。

Completely different grammatical roles.

Important distinction 5: **file = store vs file = submit**

Store/organize

> file the letter

把信件歸檔

Submit formally

> file a complaint

正式提出投訴

The object strongly determines the meaning.

Important distinction 6: **file a complaint vs make a complaint**

make a complaint

complain; can be informal or formal.

file a complaint

formally submit it into an official process.

So **file** emphasizes administrative/legal registration.

Important distinction 7: **file a lawsuit vs sue**

file a lawsuit

formally begin the court case.

sue someone

bring legal action against someone.

> She sued the company.

她控告公司。

> She filed a lawsuit against the company.

她正式向法院提起訴訟。

Important distinction 8: **file for X vs file X**

file a complaint

submit a particular document/action.

file for bankruptcy

apply for a legal status/process.

The preposition **for** matters.

Important distinction 9: **on file vs in a file**

on file

formally stored in the records.

> We have your details on file.

我們已有你的資料存檔。

in a file

physically/digitally inside one particular file.

> The information is in this file.

資料在這個檔案裏。

Important distinction 10: **file away vs save**

file away

organize/store for future reference.

save

broader, especially digital storage.

> file away old records

把舊紀錄歸檔

> save a document

儲存文件

Important distinction 11: **file vs filing**

file

can be the individual item or verb.

filing

can mean:

- * act of filing
- * officially submitted document
- * system/process

> court filing

法院提交文件

> filing system

歸檔系統

Important distinction 12: **file as tool vs file as document**

Tool

> use a file on metal

用銼刀磨金屬

Document/data

> open a file

打開檔案

Completely unrelated modern senses.

Important distinction 13: **file nails vs cut nails**

cut nails

shorten them substantially.

file nails

smooth and shape their edges.

Important distinction 14: **single file vs queue**

single file

describes physical arrangement: one behind another.

queue

people waiting their turn.

A group can walk in single file without being in a queue.

Important distinction 15: **file into a room vs enter**

enter

simply go inside.

file into

go inside one after another in an orderly stream.

> The students entered the hall.

學生進入禮堂。

> The students filed into the hall.

學生**魚貫而入**。

Important distinction 16: **file name vs file path**

file name

name of the file.

file path

full location of the file inside drives/folders.

Example conceptually:

> folder / subfolder / filename

The path tells you where it is; the filename tells you what it is called.

Family-extension note

File is a genuinely rich polysemy word with several major branches:

1. **digital item**

- * open a file
- * save a file
- * file format

2. **administrative record**

- * case file
- * personnel file
- * on file

3. **verb: organize/store records**

- * file documents
- * file away

4. **verb: formally submit**

- * file a complaint
- * file a claim
- * file a lawsuit
- * file taxes
- * file for bankruptcy

5. **tool**

- * metal file
- * nail file
- * file your nails

6. **line of people**

- * single file
- * file into
- * file past

For your passage, the relevant branch is clearly:

file = individual digital item stored inside a folder

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
file (digital)	電子檔案	stored digital item
open a file	打開檔案	access content
save a file	儲存檔案	store data
download a file	下載檔案	remote → local
upload a file	上傳檔案	local → remote
delete a file	刪除檔案	remove
attach a file	附加檔案	add to message
share a file	分享檔案	give access
file name	檔案名稱	identifier
file format	檔案格式	data type
file extension	副檔名	suffix/type marker
file system	檔案系統	storage organization
file (records)	檔案；卷宗	collected records
case file	案件卷宗	case records
personnel file	人事檔案	employee records
medical file	醫療檔案	medical records
on file	已存檔	stored officially
file documents	把文件歸檔	organize/store
file away	收好歸檔	store for reference
file a complaint	正式提出投訴	official submission
file a claim	提出申索	claim formally
file a lawsuit	提起訴訟	start legal case
file charges	正式提出控罪	criminal charge
file taxes	報稅	tax submission
file for bankruptcy	申請破產	formal application

file for divorce	提出離婚申請	legal application	
filing	歸檔 / 申報文件	filing act/document	
file (tool)	銼刀	smoothing tool	
nail file	指甲銼	nail tool	
file (verb/tool)	銼 ; 磨平	smooth with file	
filings	銼屑	small particles	
file (line)	縱列	one-behind-another line	
single file	一路縱隊	one by one	
file into/out of	魚貫進入 / 離開	orderly movement	
file past	魚貫經過	move past in line	

For your original sentence

> Later that evening, Kevin checked the shared folder again and realised that he had opened the wrong **file**.

Here:

file = 共享資料夾裏其中一個具體的電子檔案

The neat contrast is:

> **folder** = 存放和整理檔案的「容器」

> **file** = 容器裏具體的一個數碼項目

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> Kevin 再次檢查共享資料夾，才發現自己**打開了錯的檔案**。

And that detail explains the whole misunderstanding: the speaker's work **had been there all along**—Kevin simply looked at the wrong digital file.